

STEFFEN SIMMONS

Gameplay Designer & Systems Programmer

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★ Student Projects

Design Director | Gameplay Programmer | Build Master

August 2024 - April 2025

WAKE - 1st Person Shooter, GODOT

- Led 8 other programmers by creating & maintaining a development roadmap of project features
- Built several varied systems, including dynamic weather and predictive ballistics physics using GODOT's Physics Server architecture
- Reduced combat agent 3D navigation time 93% through dynamic NavMesh generation & blocked terrain analysis
- Automated game building & testing through the use of a Jenkins server

Audio Programmer | Gameplay Programmer

August 2023 - April 2024

Mercy For Machines - 3rd Person Horror Game, Unreal Engine 5

- Integrated our custom AI stealth system with Wwise attenuation
- Worked closely with the team's audio producer to tailor systems to their sound direction for game scenes & characters

Technical Lead | Gameplay / Graphics / Physics Programmer

August 2022 - April 2023

Strike Back - 2D Fighting Game, Custom C++ Engine

- Shipped on Steam with 20,000+ downloads since release
- Led and managed a team of 5 programmers in writing a Custom OpenGL C++ engine
- Created shaders letting artists hot swap values across an entire character's sprite animation set
- Experimented with & implemented numerous VFX shaders at our artist's behest
- Built a Runge-Kutta 4th order physics integrator and a custom collision-solver system

★ Professional Experience

Contract Animation Tools Programmer

June 2018 - August 2019

Roots & Charms: Farming Magic! - 1st Person Farming, Unity

- Built an animation controller to dynamically modifying animation layers of farmed plants during runtime through an Editor GUI
- Collaborated across departments to add requested features to the team's development tools

Freelance Gameplay & Physics Programmer | Game Designer

March 2017 - October 2017

Rider Die - 3rd Person Combat Racing, Unity

- Prototyped car-movement mechanics and a part crafting/attachment system in C# for our vehicle controller
- Used telemetry gathered from playtesting to balance systems based on verbal & nonverbal player feedback

Contract Level Designer

May 2016 - March 2017

Omegatech: Aspen's Story - Isometric Mech Combat, Unity

- Blocked out level surfaces for several level 'sub-scenes' that were used in larger dynamic levels
- Set-Dressed multiple scenes while working with the team's environment artists
- Created player-initiated camera compositions within level 'sub-scenes' for narrative and combat purposes

★ Skills

C / C# / C++

GDScript / UE Blueprints

GIT / Perforce

Build Automation

Trello / Asana / Notion

Game Systems Design

2D / 3D Combat Design

Encounter Design

Rapid Prototyping

Environmental Query Systems

GOAP Agent Systems

Parallelization

Navmesh Optimization

Nintendo SDev Development

Custom Engine Development

OpenGL Development

Wwise Integration

🎓 Education

Bachelor of Science: Computer Science & Game Design

August 2021 - April 2025

Digipen Institute of Technology

- Dean's List